

Ian Taylor

Software Engineer · Los Angeles, CA

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with 4+ years building production web apps for gaming communities at ZAM. On Wowhead, builds interactive game tools in React and TypeScript and led the codebase's move to React, which now powers about 70% of the site. Previously led Fanbyte's rebuild from WordPress to Next.js and Strapi. Brings a background in leading retail teams and building point-of-sale tooling, with a focus on the people using the product.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer · ZAM

Remote · Mar 2022 – Present

Wowhead 2023 – Present

- Introduced React and TypeScript into Wowhead's long-lived codebase; about 70% of the site now runs on React, with new features shipping as typed, reusable components.
- Built the player-housing tools: community housing builds with a full build editor (690+ builds shared), a decor database of 2,200+ items with 3D previews, and player-curated decor collections.
- Built interactive planners with shareable links, including the World of Warcraft talent calculator, the Diablo IV build planner, and the WoW Forever tier list creator and legacy calculator.

Fanbyte 2022 – 2023

- Led the rebuild of Fanbyte, a games news and guides site, from WordPress to a headless Next.js, TypeScript, and Strapi stack.
- Designed structured Strapi content types for the editorial team, replacing free-form WordPress posts.
- Designed and built an internal ad tech revenue dashboard.

Supervisor / POS Engineer · Providence Health & Services

Burbank, CA · Aug 2019 – Mar 2022

- Designed a refreshed point-of-sale UI used across 9 Starbucks stores, increasing customer flow and speed of service by 25%.
- Engineered and maintained a unified inventory management system for 9 stores, reducing waste by 20%.
- Wrote the SQL queries behind store reporting, increasing visibility and reducing cost of goods by 18% per store.

Web Developer · Freelance

Remote · Jan 2015 – Mar 2022

- Built a React e-commerce site for a local LGBT-owned business and a private fan-club site for a Twitch streamer with Node.js and React.

Earlier experience

Supervisor, Starbucks Coffee Company · Mar 2012 – Oct 2019: rolled out a ticket-printer system that increased speed of service by 20%.

Senior Quality Assurance Engineer, Nexicore Services · May 2007 – May 2012: developed a testing method that cut testing time by 25–50% and doubled average testing capacity.

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, PHP, SQL, HTML, CSS
Frontend	React, Next.js, responsive UI, accessibility
Backend & data	Node.js, Strapi, MySQL, PostgreSQL, REST APIs
Tooling	Git, Vite, Webpack, Claude Code (AI-assisted development)

EDUCATION

Software Engineering Career Track · Springboard

Feb 2021 – Feb 2022

Full-stack certification with 1:1 industry mentorship and four portfolio projects covering front-end, back-end, databases, and data structures and algorithms.